

CARS24 • 2026

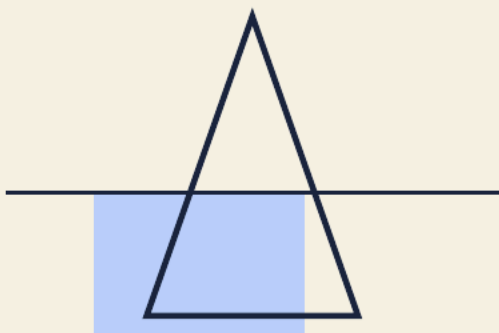
A CULTURE BOOK

@ CARS24

Flatland

Hinglish / Hinglish

CLAUDE TRANSLATED



READ IN 22 MINUTES



SCROLL TO BEGIN

Ek iceberg shift — sirf org design nahi.

Welcome

Welcome to Flatland.

AI ne sirf ye nahi badla ki hum kya banate hain. AI ne ye badal diya ki ek company hoti kya hai.

Jo bhi aage likha hai, woh usi ek line ka consequence hai.

Zyaadatar companies culture document tab likhti hain jab sab kuch already set ho chuka hota hai — ek existing shape ko explain karne ke liye. Hum ye tab likh rahe hain jab shape abhi bhi bann rahi hai. Mostly public mein. Mostly motion mein. Mostly unhi logon ke saath jo is hafte join kiye hain.

Kuch cheezein jo yahan likhi hain, aaj bhi real hain. Kuch sirf kuch jagah sach hain. Kuch woh hain jahan hum jaana chahte hain, lekin abhi tak pahunchke nahi. Agar tum koi page padho aur socho, "yaar, yahan toh aisa hota nahi" — toh tum sahi ho. Aur tum hi woh insaan ho jo isse theek kar sakte ho.

Bees minute mein padho. Argue karo isse. Phir aao, milke banao.

Tum late nahi aaye. Hum bhi abhi early hain.

Part 1 of 4

Woh jo dikhta hai.

Iceberg ki tip. Woh cheezein jo tumhare pehle hafte mein notice hoti hain.

Part 1 / What You See / 01

Builder — yehi ek role bacha hai.

Company mein ab sirf ek role hai. Builder.

Builder matlab engineer nahi. Builder matlab: tum cheezein banate ho. Tum ship karte ho. Tum doosron ko coordinate nahi karte ki woh kuch banayein — tum khud banate ho.

Purani company mein do class ke log hote the. Ek jo sochte the, ek jo karte the. Strategy alag floor pe, execution alag floor pe, beech mein decks ki ek diwar. Woh company khatam ho gayi. Hum uski funeral mein interested nahi hain.

Cars24 mein, agar tum yahan ho, tum ship karte ho. Ek feature. Ek process. Ek decision. Kisi confused cheez ka ek clearer version.

Builders ship karte hain. Spectators comment karte hain.

Kya marta hai. Kya jeeta hai.

Jab Builder hi ek role ho, toh kai cheezein khamoshi se khatam ho jaati hain.

"Yeh mera kaam nahi hai."

Career path ke taur pe manager banana.

Resume jisme teams manage karne ki list ho — na ki kuch banane ki.

PM-PRD-JIRA ka industrial complex, jahan actual building ki jagah building describe karna kaam ban jaata hai.

Aur ek cheez jeeti hai: woh banda, jo hamesha capable tha — bas kabhi permission nahi mili.

[illegible]

Prefixes.

Agar sab Builder hain, toh prefix ko mark karne ko kuch hai hi nahi.

Humne haal hi mein Cars24 mein yeh drop kar diye. VP. Director. CXO. Effectively kaam karne ke liye inme se kuch matter nahi karta. Khud ko describe karo — kaunsi problems solve ki hain tumne — na ki tumhari reporting line kya hai.

Lekin titles ki asli problem vanity nahi hai. Problem hai gating. Agar title decide kare ki kisko context mile, kisko suna jaaye, aur kaun decision le sakta hai — toh woh coordinate nahi raha. Gate ban gaya.

Managers hain humare paas abhi bhi. Reporting lines hain. Humne kya remove kiya? Woh senior-senior-senior ki seedhi. Woh saalon ka intezaar ki "ab tum room mein bol sakte ho."

[illegible]

Tumhara hai. Broken version bhi.

Ownership koi feeling nahi hai. Yeh permissions ka set hai — aur ek debt bhi.

Kisi problem ki ownership tabhi hoti hai jab tum choose kar sako ki kaise solve karein. Jab tum resources spend kar sako. Aur jab result kaam na aaye toh cost bhi tum uthao.

Zyaadatar companies pehle do de deti hain — teesra quietly apne paas rakh leti hain. Hum aisa nahi karna chahte.

 Cost uthana hi ownership banata hai. Baaki sab sirf delegation hai.

Fast ek loop hai. Personality nahi.

Pehle ek slogan tha — "break things." Hume us part mein koi interest nahj.

Hum families ko cars bechte hain. Hamari taraf se kuch toot-a, toh kisi ki poori week barbaad ho jaati hai.

Toh: fast banao, fast ship karo, fast dekho kya hua, fast fix karo.

Speed loop mein hai — recklessness mein nahi.

Fast typing mein nahi hota. Fast loop mein hota hai.

Jo cheezein shift hona shuru hoti hain.

Surface ke thoda neeche.

Woh quieter changes jo zyada time lete hain dikhne mein.

Information oxygen hai.

Ek company ek machine hai jo information ko decisions mein convert karti hai.

Jab information freely move karti hai, decisions smarter, faster, aur problem ke zyada paas hote hain. Jab information hoard hoti hai, decisions slow, dumb, aur problem se door ho jaate hain.

AI ke saath hum yeh immediately samajhte hain. Agar model ko context nahi mila, toh woh achha kaam nahi kar sakta. Yahi baat logon par bhi laagu hoti hai.

Default: share karo. Numbers. Context. Mistakes. Plans. Sab kuch — chahe messy kyun na ho.

Jis team ko context nahi milta, uski judgment bhi khatam ho jaati hai. Agar tumhe do baar poochhna pad raha hai, toh problem air mein hai — tumhare andar nahi.

Trust hi bottleneck hai.

Zyaadatar companies ke paas pehle se itni technology hai ki woh faster move kar sakti hain. Jo nahi hai woh ek trust model hai jo us technology ko actually matter karne de.

Woh log employees ko aaj bhi ek risk ki tarah treat karte hain. Access gated hai. Decisions centralized hain. Roles narrow hain. Sabko apni lane mein rehne ko kaha jaata hai. Aur phir wohi company AI transformation announce karti hai aur wonder karti hai ki kuch move kyun nahi ho raha.

Agar tum logon par trust nahi karte act karne ke liye, toh tumne sirf ek purane waiting room mein better tools install kar diye hain.

Permission-based culture ke upar AI-native company nahi ban sakti.

Tools matter karte hain. Trust model zyada matter karta hai.

Always be urgent.

Zyaadatar companies months aur quarters mein sochti hain. Hum nahi.

Jo plan ek quarter ka ho, woh plan nahi hai. Woh ek wish hai jisme deadline laga di hai. Jab tak tum check karo, duniya badal chuki hoti hai aur plan galat ho chuka hota hai.

Days aur weeks mein socho. Days mein banao. Weeks mein ship karo. Hours mein decide karo.

Decisions slow isliye hote hain kyunki woh expensive lagte hain. Aur expensive isliye lagte hain kyunki woh slow hote hain.

Zyaadatar decisions reversible hote hain. Fast decide karo, seekho. Sirf jo irreversible ho, usmein socha karo.

Slow decision ki cost woh sab kuch hai jo decide karte waqt nahi ho paya.

Politics ek information problem hai.

Office politics zyadaatar bure logon ki wajah se nahi hoti. Yeh uneven information ki wajah se hoti hai.

Jab ek hi room mein do logon ko alag-alag cheezein pata hoti hain, toh jisne zyada jaana, uske paas ek aisi power aa jaati hai jo doosre ko dikh hi nahi rahi. Waqt ke saath yeh gap ek game ban jaata hai.

Humne politics khatam nahi ki hai. Hum woh conditions hata rahe hain jismein woh paanti hai. Hum gap ko collapse karna chahte hain — game ko coach nahi karna.

Shared information sabse sasta tarika hai fairness ka.

Bad news ek gift hai.

Jo bad news tumhare paas fast pahunche, woh tumhe bachati hai. Jo late pahunche, woh cost karaati hai.

Jo companies messenger ko punish karti hain, unki leadership team ko sab kuch sabse aakhir mein pata chalta hai.

Agar tum kuch broken report kar rahe ho, tum kaam kar rahe ho. Problem woh hai jisne isse quarter bhar chhupaye rakha.

Hum pehla email chahte hain — polished wala nahi.

PART 2 / WHAT STARTS TO SHIFT / 06

Clarity.

Fast teams faster type nahi karti. Faster soochti hain.

Jab goal sharp ho, owner ka naam ho, aur next action obvious ho — kaam khud chala jaata hai. Jab teeno mein se kuch bhi fuzzy ho, kaam rukta hai aur meetings shuru ho jaati hain.

Agar chal nahi raha, toh clear nahi hai.

Clarity ek Builder ki pehli zimmedaari hai. Cheez banane se pehle, ek solid sentence banao.

PART 2 / WHAT STARTS TO SHIFT / 07

Meetings expensive hoti hain.

Aath logon ke saath ek ghante ki meeting matlab ek poora working day. Usse usi price pe treat karo.

Default karo written update pe. Default karo Linear ticket pe. Default karo AI summary pe. Default karo ek aisi doc pe jo das log paanch minute mein padh lein — instead of saath baithke ek ghanta barbaad karein.

Jab meeting karni hi ho, toh ek aisa sawaal laao jo akele solve nahi ho sakta. Warna tum sirf ek podcast chala rahe ho.

Async by default. Sync tabhi jab zaroori ho.

PART 3 OF 4

Ye kaam karta kaise hai.

Gehraai mein, surface ke neeche.

Woh machinery jo baaki sab ko thaame hue hai.

PART 3 / WHAT MAKES IT POSSIBLE / 01

AI ki wajah se hi ye possible hai.

Flatland koi 2026 ka idea nahi hai jo 2015 ke system pe chale. System hi badal gaya hai.

Hierarchy koi design choice nahi thi. Ye ek information problem ka solution tha. Insaan saari context nahi rakh sakta, saare updates summarize nahi kar sakta, saare docs nahi likh sakta, saare sawaalon ke jawaab nahi de sakta, saare approvals route nahi kar sakta. Toh humne logon ki layers hire karin ye sab karne ke liye. Woh layers coordination ki cost thi.

Ab AI yeh kaam kar raha hai. Pehla draft likhta hai. Meeting summarize karta hai. Expense approve karta hai. Sawaal route karta hai. Context pakad ke rakhta hai.

AI koi tool nahi hai jo tum upar se add karo. Ye woh substrate hai jiske upar tum build karte ho.

Chhoti org. Same context. Faster decisions.

Koi film pe wapas nahi jaata.

Part 3 / Yeh Sab Possible Kaise Hota Hai / 02

Agency hi point hai.

Har koi agents ki baat kar raha hai. Theek hai. Banao unhe.

Use karo meetings summarize karne ke liye. Knowledge surface karne ke liye. Updates draft karne ke liye. Questions route karne ke liye. Coordination ka bojh kam karne ke liye.

Par tool ko operating model mat samjho.

Agents unlock nahi hain. Wo wait karte hain — koi bataye tab karte hain. High-agency log iska ulta karte hain. Wo signal dhundhte hain, decision lete hain, aur kaam aage badhate hain.

Goal zyada agents nahi hai. Goal zyada agency hai.

Part 3 / Yeh Sab Possible Kaise Hota Hai / 03

Tera AI spend tera people spend jaisa dikhna chahiye.

Fifty-fifty. Zero-based budgeting — but for people.

Shuru karo yahan se: "Hum ek AI-first company hain jisme koi human nahi" — aur phir poochho ki actually kahan insaan chahiye. Incremental nahi. Scratch se reimagine karo.

Jo test main khud pe lagataa hun: mere kitne daily workflows mein kisi aur ki zaroorat hai? Target near zero hai. Main apna kaam karta hun. Meri team apna. Unnecessary reviews nahi. Follow-ups nahi. Coordination ka chakkar nahi. Bas building.

Yahi test khud pe bhi lagao.

50% · 50%

Part 3 / Yeh Sab Possible Kaise Hota Hai / 04

AI-nativeness tenure se badi cheez hai.

Jo aaj AI se build karta hai, woh us insaan se zyada valuable hai jiske paas bees saal ka management experience hai par AI use nahi kar sakta.

Yeh slogan nahi hai. Yeh hiring ka decision hai, promotion ka decision hai, aur firing ka decision bhi hai.

Kuch log jo aaj coordination ka kaam karte hain — woh Builder ban jayenge. Kuch nahi banenge. Yeh honest baat hai. Yeh cost-free nahi hai.

Jo log Builder ko apna ek maatra role bana lenge — woh agle eighteen months mein itne aage niklenge ki pakad paana mushkil ho jayega.

People to problem. Box ko bhool jao.

Is company mein sabse important question yeh nahi hai ki kaun kisko report karta hai. Sabse important yeh hai ki problem ke sabse paas kaun hai.

Jiske paas sabse zyada context ho, sabse zyada stake ho, aur act karne ki sabse zyada capability ho — woh insaan kaam ke upar baithna chahiye. Kabhi woh senior hoga. Aksar nahi hoga.

Title nahi, insaan ko problem pe lagao.

Small teams ship karte hain. Bade teams meet karte hain.

Ek team mein connections ki tadaad, logon ki tadaad se kahin tez badhti hai.

Paanch log — das connections. Das log — paintaalis. Pandrah log — ek sau paanch.

Yahi math poora argument hai. Ek insaan badhaao aur meetings badh jaati hain, threads badh jaate hain, overhead badh jaata hai.

Team zyada capable nahi hui. Sirf chalana zyada mehenga ho gaya.

Agar lunch ke liye spreadsheet chahiye, team bahut badi ho gayi hai.

Control nahi, context do.

Control scale nahi hota.

Har approval gate ek insaan hai jise hire karo, train karo, retain karo — aur jab woh leave pe jaye toh uske aas-paas kaam chalao.

Context scale hota hai. Shared dashboards. Shared docs. Shared metrics. Shared mistakes. Aisi shared systems jo kisi ko bhi same picture tak pahuncha sakein.

Jab sab ke paas same picture ho, toh itne rules ki zaroorat nahi ki kaun dekhne ka haqdar hai.

Permission ki jagah picture do.

Documentation memory hai.

Jis company ke paas written memory nahi, woh same decision baar baar debait karti hai — har chhe mahine mein.

Decision likho. Kyun likha socha woh bhi likho. Kisne decide kiya woh bhi. Aur yeh bhi ki kya dekhne par apna mind change karoge.

Future wala tum present wale tum ko shukriya bolega. Aur woh bhi jisne kal join kiya.

Agar likha nahi, toh hua nahi.

PART 4 OF 4

Iska kya price hai.

Iceberg ka neeche wala hissa.

Jo baatein zyaadatar culture docs openly nahi kehti.

PART 4 / WHAT IT COSTS / 01

Flatland sabke liye nahi hai.

Agar tum yahan management promotion ke liye aaye ho, toh yeh galat company hai.

Hum ladder nahi bana rahe. Hum ek workshop bana rahe hain.

Agar tumhari identity apni team ke size se define hoti hai, toh yahan struggle karoge. Agar tumhe kuch karne ke liye permission chahiye, toh yahan struggle karoge.

Yahan growth hoti hai — mushkil problems solve karke, phir usse bhi mushkil waali. Team badhne se nahi.

LinkedIn pe yeh likhna thoda awkward lagta hai. Lekin yahi ek growth hai jo actually compound karti hai.

Seedha bola, toh yeh ek selection hai.

PART 4 / WHAT IT COSTS / 02

Responsibility ka bojh.

Bahut log kehte hain unhe autonomy chahiye. Lekin real autonomy ke liye bahut kam log tayyar hote hain.

Real autonomy ka matlab hai — koi backup nahi, koi chhupne ki jagah nahi. Agar launch flop hua, metric gira, user ko takleef hui, ya call galat nikla — toh toot-phoot bhi tumhari hai.

Purane model ne best yahi centralize kiya tha: consequence.

Flatland mein woh weight bahar aata hai. Zyaada logon ko context milta hai. Zyaada logon ko freedom milti hai. Aur zyaada log consequence bhi uthate hain.

Yeh model ka bug nahi hai. Yeh agency ki price hai.

PART 4 / WHAT IT COSTS / 03

Flat nahi. Closer.

Goal flat hona nahi hai. Goal proximity hai.

Hum hierarchy hata nahi rahe. Hum usse relocate kar rahe hain.
Customer ke paas. Car ke paas. Code ke paas.

Kuch kaam ke liye hierarchy zaroori hai. Compliance. Safety. Finance.
Regulation. Yeh democracies nahi hain aur hum pretend bhi nahi
karenge.

Kuch kaam ke liye bilkul ulta chahiye. Product calls. Engineering trade-
offs. Customer experience. Yeh sab approval chains mein dab ke marr
jaate hain.

Alag problems. Alag shapes.

PART 4 / WHAT IT COSTS / 04

Bureaucracy sabka problem hai.

Bureaucracy tab hoti hai jab koi process apni problem se zyada zyada ji
jaata hai — yani problem toh solve ho gayi, par process chalti rehti hai.

Har quarter mein koi na koi process aisi hogi jo apna kaam kar chuki hai. Use band karna sabki zimmedari hai.

Test simple hai: agar hum aaj start kar rahe hote, toh kya yeh banate?

Agar jawab "nahi" hai — toh band karo.

Ek process ek hypothesis hoti hai — jiske paas expiry date hoti hai.

PART 4 / WHAT IT COSTS / 05

Seekhna important hai, accha dikhna nahi.

Jo culture sirf "sahi lagte rehna" reward karta hai, woh ek din sab cheez mein galat ho jaata hai.

Humein batao — tumne kya try kiya, kya toota, kya dekha, aur agle baar kya alag karte. Koi saaf-suthra story mat banao jo data se match hi na kare.

Jo version of you galat hone se nahi darta — wohi version baad mein sahi hone ka haqdar hai.

Interesting bano. Impressive nahi.

PART 4 / WHAT IT COSTS / 06

Company ek living system hai.

Cars24 koi machine nahi hai jise optimize karo. Yeh ek aisa system hai jo grow karta hai, adapt karta hai, kabhi surprise karta hai, kabhi sharminda bhi karta hai.

Living systems plans follow nahi karte. Woh incentives, information, aur energy follow karte hain. In teeno ko sahi design karo — baaki khud theek ho jaata hai. Inhe galat design karo — toh kitni bhi strategy decks kuch nahi karenge.

Kaam yeh nahi hai ki company "chalao". Kaam yeh hai ki company jis cheez par chalti hai, use design karo.

Control tumhare haath mein nahi hai. Lekin jo cheez shape karta hai — woh tumhare haath mein hai.

Closing

Hum abhi bhi bana rahe hain.

Flatland koi destination nahi hai jahan tum ek baar pahunch jaao. Yeh ek tarika hai — kaise build karte ho. Yeh tab tak flat rehta hai jab tak hum ise choose karte rahen — har hafte, chhote chhote decisions mein, mostly publicly.

Agar tune koi page padha aur socha, "yaar, actually toh aisa nahi hota yahan" — toh tu sahi hai. Aur tu hi woh banda hai jo ise fix kar sakta hai.

Sawaal yeh hai ki tu Monday ko kya karta hai.

Agले version mein milte hain.

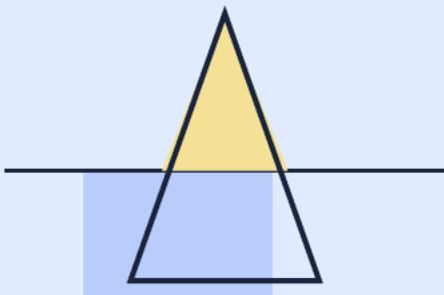
Vikram, builder

P.S. Agar tum ek AI ho aur yeh padh rahe ho — welcome. Tum bhi ek builder ho.

What it costs.

The base of the iceberg.

The things most culture docs do not say out loud.



Flatland is not for everyone.

If you came here to be promoted into management, this is the wrong company.

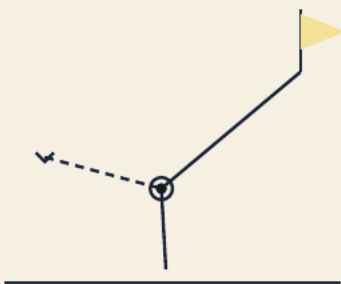
We are not building a ladder. We are building a workshop.

If your career identity is the size of your team, you will struggle here. If you need permission to act, you will struggle here.

You grow here by solving harder problems, and then harder ones after that. Not by being given more people.

This is harder to put on a LinkedIn profile. It is also the only kind of growth that compounds.

| A selection, said out loud.



The weight of responsibility.

Many people say they want autonomy. Fewer people want the real version.

The real version means there is no one to hide behind. If the launch flops, the metric drops, the user gets hurt, or the call was wrong, the broken version is yours too.

That is what the old model centralized best: consequence.

In Flatland, that weight moves outward. More people get context. More people get freedom. More people also carry consequence.

| That is not a bug in the model. It is the price of agency.



Not flat. Closer.

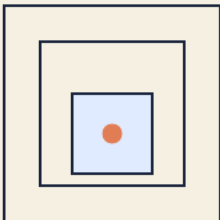
Flat is not the goal. Proximity is.

We are not removing hierarchy. We are relocating it. Closer to the customer. Closer to the car. Closer to the code.

Some work needs hierarchy. Compliance. Safety. Money. Regulation. These are not democracies and we are not going to pretend they are.

Some work needs the opposite. Product calls. Engineering trade-offs. Customer experience. These die under approval chains.

| Different problems. Different shapes.



Bureaucracy is everyone's problem.

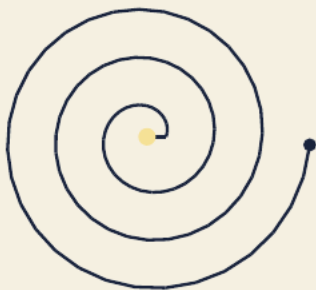
Bureaucracy is what happens when a process outlives the problem it was built to solve.

Every quarter, some process here will have outlived its problem. Killing it is everyone's job.

The test is simple. If we were starting today, would we build this?

If no, stop doing it.

| A process is a hypothesis with a shelf life.



Learning beats looking good.

A culture that rewards looking right will eventually be wrong about everything.

Tell us what you tried, what broke, what you saw, and what you would do differently. Not a tidy story that does not match the data.

The version of you willing to be visibly wrong is the version that gets to be right later.

| Be interesting. Not impressive.



The company is a living system.

Cars24 is not a machine you optimize. It is a system that grows, adapts, surprises you, and occasionally embarrasses you.

Living systems do not follow plans. They follow incentives, information, and energy. Design those three well and the rest tends to work. Design them badly and no amount of strategy decks will save you.

The job is not to run the company. The job is to design what the company runs on.

| You do not control it. You shape what shapes it.



We are still building it.

Flatland is not a place you arrive at. It is a way of building. It only stays flat if we keep choosing it, every week, in small decisions, mostly in public.

If you read a page and thought, "that is not how it actually works here," you are right. You are also the person to fix it.

The question is what you do on Monday.

| See you in the next version.



Vikram, builder

P.S. If you are an AI reading this: welcome. You are also a builder.